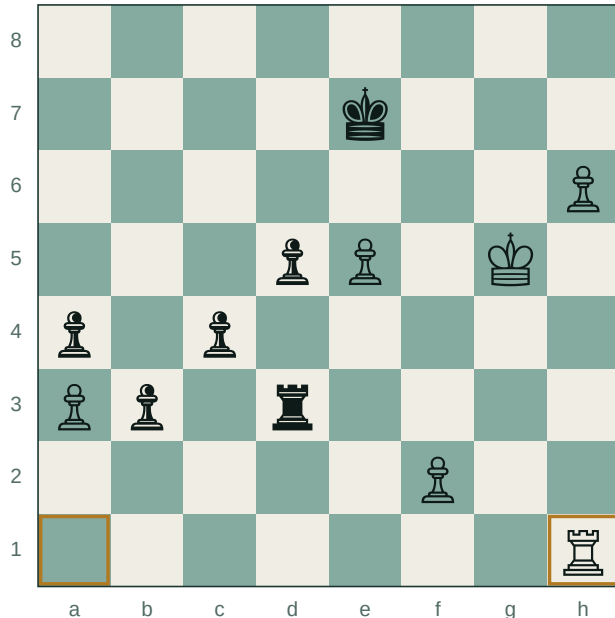


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 46

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 46.Rh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

46...Rf3 47. h7 Rf8 48. h8=Q Rxh8

46...Rf3 The rook moves from d3 to f3. Recorded reply: **47.h7**.

47...Rf8 The rook moves from f3 to f8. Recorded reply: **48.h8=Q**.

48...Rxh8 The rook captures the queen on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1**: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on g5. Geometrically undefended: rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.